8 Projects (optional, for fun) FULL

Project 2: Backups you can trust

Quick version

No time to read it all? This is the short version. The full guide is below.

- Your garden already backs itself up every night at 2:30 am. Here you keep a copy somewhere else and practise a restore.
- 30 minutes. A USB stick (16 GB or more) if you don't have one.
- Make a backup: menu `6`, then `1`. Check it: `bash garden.sh verify`.
- Copy the newest `.tar` file from the `backups` folder onto the USB stick.
- Practise a restore: menu `7`, pick the backup, say **y**. It saves what is there first (a `before-restore` backup).
- Habit: every Sunday, copy the newest backup to the USB stick. Keep the stick away from the laptop.
- Easier still: connect your NAS (menu `6`, then `4`) and Google Drive (menu `6`, then `5`). Then every backup is copied there by itself.

What you will build

Your garden already backs itself up every night at 2:30 am. In this project you make sure a copy also lives **somewhere else**, and you practise a restore, so you know it works before you ever need it.

Time and cost

30 minutes. A USB stick (16 GB or more) if you don't have one.

What you need first

The install is done. Read 13 Backups and folder names.

Steps

1. **Make a backup now:** menu `6`, then `1`. *You should see:* `Saved: junsgarden-backup_DATE_TIME.tar` and its size.
2. **Check it:** in a terminal in the garden folder, `bash garden.sh verify`. *You should see:* the manifest (what is inside) and "every piece matches its fingerprint".
3. **See the nightly schedule:** `crontab -l`. *You should see:* one line with `garden.sh backup nightly`.
4. **Copy it off the laptop.** Plug in the USB stick. Open **Files**, go to the garden folder, then `backups`. Drag the newest `.tar` file onto the USB stick. From Windows, the Windows menu `M`, `10` copies the newest backup to the PC for you.
5. **Practise a restore** (safe: it saves what is there first). Menu `7`, pick the backup you just made, say **y**. *You should see:* "Restored ... plants, ... image files", then the health line. A `before-restore` backup now exists too.

How you know it worked

- A backup from today is on the USB stick (or the PC).
- The restore finished and the site still shows your plants.
- The checklist (menu `5`) shows "Newest backup ... (0 days old)".

Make it a habit

Every Sunday: copy the newest backup to the USB stick. Keep the stick somewhere other than next to the laptop.

If something goes differently

What you see	What to do
"a piece ... is damaged"	That backup file is broken (often a bad copy). Use another one. Check the disk with the checklist.
The USB stick is too small	Backups include every photo (about 800 MB). Use a bigger stick, or keep only the newest.
The nightly line is missing	Menu `1` (install) puts it back.

Make it yours

- Connect your NAS (menu `6`, then `4`) and Google Drive (menu `6`, then `5`): after that, every backup is copied there by itself. No commands to learn.
- Have a Windows PC? The Windows menu (`M`, then `13`) copies the newest backup to it every week.
- Read about the 3-2-1 rule: https://www.backblaze.com/blog/the-3-2-1-backup-strategy/